

RSN Platform Changes and Errors from Call with Shradha

Source

Impromptu Google Meet Meeting, March 15

This document turns the call into a structured master list of bugs, corrections, missing features, and architectural clarifications.

1. Critical Functional Errors and Bugs

1.1 Login and Session Bugs

- Users still have to log in twice.
- Session is not persisting correctly after login.
- Admin appears to get logged out unexpectedly after event completion.
- Invite flow sometimes logs the user in, but then closes or behaves inconsistently.

1.2 Invite Flow Bugs

- Event invite link flow is unstable.
- Invite page opens and closes unexpectedly.
- Login from invite does not complete reliably.
- Sending a second invite can produce: "fail to create invite".
- It is unclear whether an invited user has actually joined or not after clicking invite links.

1.3 Lobby and Live Event Bugs

- Users can enter the waiting room before the host starts the event.
- Participant can see "host is offline" while the host is in fact online.
- Lobby does not properly show who is present.
- Host cannot clearly see all participants present before starting.
- Participants cannot reliably see each other before matching starts.

1.4 Chat Bugs

- Only host chat appears to work.
- Participant chat does not work from both sides.
- Chat visibility is incomplete.
- Messages are not clearly shown in real time for all participants.

1.5 Matching and Round Bugs

- Same two people can be matched again even after they already met in the same event.
- Encounter history is not stored properly.
- System does not prevent repeated matching.
- After round completion, rating step is missing.
- Previously existing round rating seems to have disappeared.

1.6 Event Recap Bug

- Event recap fails to load after the event.
- System displays "Could not load your recap".
- Completed event state exists, but recap data does not render.

1.7 Navigation and UI Bugs

- Clicking the bottom profile section does not correctly take the user to the profile.
- Admin quick actions and admin navigation elements are not fully clickable.
- The pending requests area in the admin is not behaving correctly from the dashboard.

1.8 Form and Field Bugs

- LinkedIn field should not require a full URL entry.
- System should auto-handle the LinkedIn base path rather than forcing users to paste the entire link.
- Profile field behaviour is too rigid for intended matching use.

1.9 Email Design Issue

- Email template design does not appear branded or correctly styled.
- Event and invite emails appear to fall back to an old or default email template.

2. Pod System Corrections

2.1 Pod Type Logic is Incorrect

The current pod setup mixes up pod type with member count.

What pod type should represent:

- The kind of pod
- The structural purpose of the pod
- The reason people are gathered

Examples of pod types:

- Reason pod
- Conversational pod
- Speed networking pod
- Webinar pod
- Physical event pod
- Chat pod
- Two sided networking pod
- One sided networking pod

What pod type should not represent:

- Maximum number of members

2.2 Max Members Logic Must Change

- Max members should be separate from pod type.
- Standard should effectively allow unlimited members unless the pod type itself forces a limit.
- If a pod type is structurally fixed, such as a two person conversational pod, the system should enforce that automatically.

2.3 Pod Editing is Incomplete

Currently pod editing only allows partial editing.

Pod editing must allow editing of:

- Pod name
- Description
- Pod type
- Visibility
- Capacity
- Access rules

- Invitation behaviour
- Any core configuration attached to the pod

2.4 Pod Copy Behaviour is Wrong

- Copying a pod should open a proper editable duplicate workflow.
- It should be obvious where the copied pod is.
- Copying should not silently create a pod without clear edit access.

2.5 Pod Member States Are Missing

Pod member management should show clear status buckets:

- Invited
- Accepted
- Declined
- No response
- Pending approval

2.6 Pod List and Browse Flow Needs Correction

Default state should show active pods.

Recommended order:

- Browse all
- Active
- Archived
- All

Also:

- Browse all should be visually distinct from a user's own pods.
- Users should clearly understand when they are browsing public pods versus viewing their own pods.

3. User Profile and Matching Data Corrections

3.1 Expertise and Interests Field is Too Small

- Expertise and interests needs to be a larger text field.
- This data will later feed AI based classification and matching.

Here:

3.2 Profile Needs Better Structured Matching Data

The profile must capture more useful matching signals, including:

- Who the user is
- What they care about
- What they can help with
- Who they want to meet
- Why they want to meet them
- Their interests
- Their expertise
- Their intent

3.3 Profile Should Become a Card

- Each profile should become a scan-friendly card.
- Card should make it easy to decide whether someone is relevant for matching.
- This is especially important for premium match selection.

Suggested card elements:

- Photo
- Name
- Short identity summary
- Interests
- Expertise
- Who they want to meet
- Reason for connecting

3.4 Premium Match Selection Feature

Premium functionality should allow users to preselect up to 12 people they want to meet for an event.

Logic should include:

- User selects preferred people
- Matching should take mutual interest into account
- Premium priority may influence tie breaking where appropriate
- System should still protect fairness and relevance

4. User Search, Invite, and Access Control Corrections

4.1 Platform User Search is Incomplete

When inviting platform users, system must support:

- Search existing users
- Filter users
- Select relevant users
- Search beyond a tiny visible list

4.2 Invite Limits Are Wrong

- Limit of 10 invited users is not sufficient.
- Invite limits should be configurable in admin.
- Some pod creators may need to invite very large groups.

4.3 Invite Permissions Must Be Role Based

Suggested permission structure:

- Super admins can invite everyone
- Standard users can only invite platform users they have encountered, matched with, or otherwise have permission to invite

4.4 User Settings Need Invitation Preferences

Users should be able to control whether they want to receive invitations to platform wide recurring events.

For example:

- I do not want invites to weekly Reason events
- I do want invite notifications from private pods I joined

4.5 Public and Private Pod Access Model Needed

Pods should support:

- Public join
- Public with approval
- Private invite only
- Request to join

4.6 Request to Join Needs Access Logic

Pod creators should be able to require:

- Join request approval
- Screening questions
- Agreement checkboxes
- Rules acknowledgement before acceptance

5. Event System Corrections

5.1 Pod and Event Must Be Separated Structurally

This is a key correction from the call.

Definitions:

Pod

A container of people gathered for a reason.

Event

A way those people engage with one another.

This distinction must exist in the product model, the UI, and the database.

5.2 Event Type Must Be Selectable When Scheduling

When scheduling an event, user must choose the event type.

Possible event types include:

- Speed networking
- Video meeting
- Voice meeting
- Ongoing chat
- Webinar
- Physical event

The current system assumes speed networking only, which is too narrow.

5.3 Event Scheduling Defaults Need Improvement

- Date and time should default to current values.
- UI should not show raw placeholder style fields as the main default.

5.4 Event Participant Tracking Must Improve

Event detail page should show:

- Invited count
- Going count
- Declined count
- Waiting for response count

Filters should allow viewing each group separately.

5.5 Invite Landing Page Needs Context

Invite page should show:

- Event name
- Who invited the user
- Why they were invited if relevant

Current invite page is too generic.

5.6 Waiting Room Logic Must Improve

- Participants should not enter waiting room before host starts event.
- Waiting room should accurately reflect host status.
- Participant presence should be visible.

5.7 Match Flow Needs Better State Control

Host flow should be:

- Match people
- Review or amend matches if needed
- Start round

This should be explicit and controlled.

5.8 Post Round Flow Needs Improvement

After each round there should be:

- Rating step
- Option to indicate desire to meet again
- Optional short extension request in future versions
- Proper transition into next round or wrap up

5.9 Event Recap Must Be Useful

Recap should show:

- Who you met
- Ratings given
- Whether there was mutual interest
- Whether there was a rematch or follow up signal
- Summary of event participation

6. Admin System Corrections

6.1 Admin Must Be a Real Control Center

Admin currently feels partial and underpowered.

Admin should include at minimum:

- User management
- Pod management
- Event management
- Invite management
- Request approvals
- Matching templates or engine settings
- Violations and moderation
- Email and automation controls
- Platform stats
- Limits and permissions settings

6.2 Bulk Actions Needed

Admin should support bulk operations such as:

- Bulk approve users
- Bulk decline users
- Bulk invite users
- Bulk manage event participants

6.3 Request Management Needs Improvement

Pending join requests should:

- Be easy to access
- Be clickable from admin dashboard
- Support status views
- Trigger correct emails on approval or decline

7. Strategic Product Architecture Clarification

This is one of the most important outputs from the call.

7.1 Proposed Structural Hierarchy

Circle

A broader community or ecosystem layer.

Examples:

- Founders
- Students
- Investors
- Tea producers
- Companies

Pod

A subgroup inside a circle, gathered for a reason.

Examples:

- Founder sparring pod
- Hiring pod
- Investor founder pod
- Students Pod
- PhD support pod

Event

A way the pod interacts.

Examples:

- Speed networking event
- Live chat event
- Voice call event
- Webinar
- Physical meetup

7.2 People and Entities

The system should ultimately support both:

- Individuals
- Entities such as companies or institutions

Entities should be able to create and manage their own structures inside the platform.

8. Commercial and Future Facing Feature Signals from the Call

These are not immediate bug fixes, but they are important directional points captured in the session.

8.1 Platform Should Support Private Professional Use Cases

Examples mentioned in the call:

- Private investor meetings
- Founder investor events
- Hiring events
- Academic groups
- Topic based communities
- Physical city based gatherings

8.2 Platform Should Become More Than RSN Events

The call reinforces that the current speed networking feature is only the first use case.

The product direction is broader:

- Group communication infrastructure
- Purpose based interaction platform
- Event and meeting infrastructure
- Human matching layer

8.3 Business Use Case Support

Companies and institutions should later be able to:

- Create circles
- Run private pods
- Schedule their own events
- Use the platform for internal or external interaction

9. Platform Branding Integration

Based on the RSN visual strategy, the platform should consistently reflect the brand identity across all user-facing surfaces.

9.1 Brand Colors Implementation

The following colors should be integrated across the platform UI.

Primary Emphasis Color

- Red: **#DE322E**
- Usage:
 - Calls to action
 - Important decisions
 - Key interaction elements
 - Notifications requiring attention

Secondary Structure Colors

- Black: **#000000** (structure, text, hierarchy)
- White: **#FFFFFF** (background and breathing space)

- Light Gray: **#F3F4F6** (UI surfaces, containers)

Guideline

- Red must be used sparingly.
- Never use red as a large background fill.
- It should signal **action, urgency, or importance**, not decoration.

9.2 Platform Entry Branding

The login experience should reinforce the brand.

Changes required:

Login Page

- Display RSN logo prominently
- Use brand red (#DE322E) for login buttons and primary actions
- Clean white background with strong spacing

Email and Invite Pages

- Should reflect RSN colors and typography
- Replace current fallback template with branded layout

Navigation

- Brand logo visible in top navigation
- Logo should link back to the main dashboard/home

10. Priority Implementation Order

Priority 1

Fix core reliability issues:

- Login persistence

- Invite flow
- Waiting room access logic
- Host status accuracy
- Participant visibility
- When logging out, a caution-like: are you sure you want to log out?

Priority 2

Fix live event functionality:

- Chat for all users
- Encounter tracking
- Repeat match prevention
- Rating flow restoration
- Event recap loading

Priority 3

Fix pod management:

- Pod type logic
- Max member separation
- Pod editing completeness
- Pod copy behaviour
- Member statuses

Priority 4

Fix search, invite, and permissions:

- Search platform users
- Filter inevitable users
- Role based invitation permissions
- User invitation preferences
- Configurable invite limits

Priority 5

Expand event model:

- Selectable event types
- Better scheduling defaults
- Participant status filters
- Invite landing page context

- Better post round flow
- Brand color alignment

Priority 6

Strengthen admin:

- Clickable admin dashboard
- Bulk approvals
- Matching templates
- Violations
- Emails and automations
- Stats and permissions

10. Simple One Line Summary

The main issues from the call are that the current platform has unstable login and invite behaviour, incomplete event and lobby logic, weak pod editing and invite controls, missing rating and encounter tracking, and a structural product gap where pods and events are not yet cleanly separated in the system.

11. Clean Developer Checklist Version

Bugs to Fix

- Fix double login issue
- Fix unstable invite login flow
- Fix second invite failure
- Fix waiting room access before host starts
- Fix false host offline state
- Fix participant visibility in lobby
- Fix participant chat
- Fix missing round rating
- Fix missing encounter tracking
- Fix repeated matching of same people
- Fix recap loading failure
- Fix unexpected admin logout
- Fix broken profile navigation
- Fix non clickable admin request navigation
- Fix LinkedIn field handling
- Fix email template styling

Functional Changes to Make

- Make expertise and interests a large text field
- Add better profile matching fields
- Turn profile into a match card
- Add premium pre selection of preferred people to meet
- Add user database search and filtering when inviting
- Add role based invite permissions
- Add configurable invite limits
- Add user settings for event invite preferences
- Separate pod type from max members
- Allow full pod editing
- Improve pod copy flow
- Add member state tracking in pods
- Correct pod list default and order
- Separate pod and event structurally
- Add selectable event types
- Improve event scheduling defaults
- Add participant status tracking for events
- Improve invite page context
- Add request to join flow for pods
- Add access questions and acceptance rules
- Restore post round rating flow
- Add meet again signal after rounds
- Build useful recap page
- Improve admin into full control layer
- Add bulk admin actions

Product Architecture Direction

- Build Circle layer above pods
- Keep pods as reason based containers
- Keep events as interaction types inside pods
- Support both individuals and entities in the long term
- Support both digital and physical event structures